

The Effect of Deadline Announcement on Task Completion Rate

Evidence from EGAP Learning Days Participants

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Slide 2 — Research Question

Research Question

Does receiving a deadline reminder increase task completion rates among workshop participants?

Proposed Answer

We hypothesize that participants who receive a deadline reminder will be more likely to complete the assigned task than participants who do not receive a reminder.

Slide 3 — Research Design (iMIDA)

Letter	Meaning
i	Inquiry (abstract)
M	Model
I	Inquiry (precise)
D	Data Strategy
A	Answer Strategy

i — Abstract Inquiry

How can simple behavioral interventions improve task completion? Many individuals intend to complete assigned tasks but fail to do so because of forgetfulness, procrastination, or competing priorities.

M — Model

Deadline Reminder → Greater Attention to Task → Less Forgetting / Less Procrastination → Higher Task Completion

I — Precise Inquiry

Does receiving a deadline reminder increase task completion rates among workshop participants?

D — Data Strategy

Randomized Controlled Trial (RCT), coin-flip assignment.

- *Treatment Group*: Receives a deadline reminder before the submission deadline.
- *Control Group*: Receives no reminder.
- *Outcome*: Binary completion (1 = submitted; 0 = not).

A — Answer Strategy

Estimate the causal effect of reminders by comparing completion rates between treatment and control groups:

$$\hat{ATE} = \bar{Y}_T - \bar{Y}_C$$

Slide 4 — Implementation Report

WHAT	A small RCT to evaluate whether receiving a deadline reminder increases task completion.
HOW	Random assignment to treatment (reminder) or control (no reminder).
TO WHOM	Workshop participants.
WHERE	Within the context of the workshop.
WHEN	During the workshop period.
WHY	Random assignment ensures comparable groups, minimizing selection bias.
WHAT WENT BADLY	The sample size was relatively small, reducing statistical power.

Slide 5 — Answering Strategy**Estimator — Difference-in-Means (OLS):**

$$Y = \beta_0 + \beta_1 \cdot X + \varepsilon$$

Where:

- Y = task completion (0 / 1)
- X = deadline treatment (0 = control, 1 = treated)
- β_1 = estimated Average Treatment Effect (ATE)

Uncertainty Estimation

We report 95% confidence intervals and p-values (HC2 heteroskedasticity-robust standard errors).

Slide 6 — Results: Regression Output

Table 1: `lm_robust(Y ~ X)` — HC2 Robust Standard Errors

	Term	Estimate	Std. Error	p-value	CI Low	CI High
(Intercept)	(Intercept)	0.8	0.1333	0.000	0.5187	1.0813
X	X (Deadline)	0.2	0.1333	0.152	-0.0813	0.4813

- **Intercept** = completion rate in the control group (no reminder).
- **Coefficient on X** = estimated ATE — the average effect of the deadline reminder on completion rate.

Slide 7 — Interpretation, Threats & Takeaways

Findings

Control group completion rate	80%
Estimated treatment effect	+20 percentage points
p-value	0.152
95% CI	[−0.08, 0.48]

Conclusion

Although participants who received a deadline reminder had a higher task completion rate, the estimated effect is **not statistically significant** ($p = 0.152$). Therefore, we **fail to reject** the null hypothesis that reminders have no effect on task completion.

Threats to Inference

- **Low power** — $DF = 17$, too small to detect modest effects
 - **Ceiling effect** — 80% control rate leaves little room to improve
 - **Spillovers** — participants may have shared deadline info (SUTVA violation)
 - **Hawthorne effect** — observation itself may have raised both groups' performance
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Slide 8 — Thank You

Thank you for your attention!

A special thank you to our instructors — we truly appreciate your guidance and dedication.

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